

A REPRIEVE AAP leader Arvind Kejriwal greets supporters after his release from jail, Sep. 13

PTI

THE KEJRIWAL GAMEPLAN

OUT ON BAIL, THE AAP CHIEF USES HIS **RESIGNATION AS A TRUMP CARD** TO COUNTER CORRUPTION CHARGES IN THE POLLS AHEAD

By Avishek G. Dastidar

"**Delhi has only one chief minister and his name is Arvind Kejriwal,"** announced the capital's new CM, Atishi. These evocative words came a mere 48 hours after Kejriwal's surprise announcement that he was resigning from the office he had held for nearly a decade—to popular acclaim initially, but ground down by attritional politics of late that saw him jailed on corruption charges. Nominated by the Aam Aadmi Party (AAP) on September 17 as Kejriwal's successor, what Atishi was suggesting is that hers was only a stopgap regency—that the icon was only in temporary eclipse.

With this tactical 'retreat offensive', Kejriwal has declared Delhi's election season open, way